

ROSETTA



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Scallops with cacahuazintle and brown butter

Callo margarita con cacahuazintle y mantequilla avellanada

Corn Tamales with celeriac and smoked cream

Tamales de elote con apionabo y crema ahumada

Amaranth cappellacci with Taleggio cheese and smoked corn broth

Cappellacci de amaranto con queso Taleggio y consomé de elote ahumado

Poached pears, elderflowers and tarragon

Peras pochadas, flor de sauco y estragón

Melipona honey jelly with brown butter ice cream and vanilla

Gelatina de miel melipona con helado de mantequilla avellanada y vainilla



Nestled on a quiet street in the Cuauhtémoc Municipality, the vibrant heart of Mexico City, Rosetta is a restaurant that exudes cozy charm, artistic sophistication, and a youthful energy. The restaurants I've chosen for my journey through Mexico City seem to come in pairs: Pujol and Quintonil represent the pinnacle of fine Mexican dining, each revisiting the country's rich agricultural heritage in its own way. Em and Rosetta, on the other hand, form a duo of fusion cuisine. After experiencing a bold cultural blend of Mexico and Japan at Em, I now find myself at Rosetta, ready to explore a different kind of collision—this time between Mexico and Italy.

Rosetta first caught my attention when it ranked No. 49 on the World's 50 Best Restaurants list in 2023, and it rose swiftly to No. 34 in 2024—now standing alongside the renowned Pujol. Naturally, I was curious to see whether the ranking was well deserved. Arriving a bit early, I was ushered upstairs to the lounge, where I found myself alone in a beautifully appointed space adorned with chinoiserie decor. I settled into a sofa, gazing out from the petite balcony, and sipped a cocktail crafted at the bar, all while taking in the intricate Chinese wall art that surrounded me.



As lunchtime approached, I was led downstairs to my table. The dining room itself is not large, nor is it ostentatious, but as sunlight poured in through the tall skylights, I felt a sense of ease and contentment unlike anything I had experienced before. Seated alone on a wooden bench, I looked out at the surrounding greenery and the delicately painted birds on the walls, and a quiet joy welled up within me. The bread arrived promptly—not remarkable, but perfectly adequate. Soon after came the first course: Scallops with cacahuazintle and brown butter (*Callo margarita con cacahuazintle y mantequilla avellanada*). The sauce, made from corn and brown butter, was bright with acidity yet rich and creamy, offering a perfect balance that awakened the palate. The aroma was deeply inviting, while the corn crisps added just the right touch of texture. The scallop itself was impressively large, tender, and naturally sweet. The corn used here—cacahuazintle—is an ancient heirloom variety of white dent maize, native to Toluca, Mexico, prized for its unique flavor and culinary versatility.



Next came the dish I had been eagerly anticipating: the tamale. A tamale is a traditional Mesoamerican preparation made from masa — a dough of nixtamalized corn — steamed in a corn husk or banana leaf. Today's offering was Corn Tamales with celeriac and smoked cream (Tamales de elote con apionabo y crema ahumada).

The smoked cream was the soul of the dish. Its aroma was deep and evocative, richly smoky yet never overpowering. It brought a sense of warmth and depth to the entirely plant-based plate, adding a subtle weight while still keeping things airy and light. Unfortunately, the portion of smoked cream felt a bit too modest—insufficient, really, for the two tamales it was meant to accompany.

The tamales themselves were well-made. The masa had a subtle, rounded flavor, and the pairing of celeriac and corn worked beautifully. The texture was excellent—tender yet substantial—and I could truly taste the richness and refinement of this heirloom corn. And yet, by the end of the second tamale, I found myself growing a little weary. The uniformity of texture, for all its quality, made the dish feel slightly repetitive when eaten alone.



The Italian influence finally made its appearance in the next course: a pasta dish featuring amaranth cappellacci with Taleggio cheese and smoked corn broth (Cappellacci de amaranto con queso Taleggio y consomé de elote ahumado). I chose this cappellacci as my main course for two reasons. First, the portion felt just right for a solo diner — light yet satisfying. Second, it would be almost inconceivable to dine at Rosetta without trying their pasta.

What first captured my attention was the broth. A delicate sip revealed a gentle sweetness with the touch of smoky tone —reminiscent of cereal-infused milk, yet far from bland. Then came the cappellacci itself. The pasta dough leaned toward the softer side, lacking the firm al dente bite I had hoped for. The Taleggio, however, did not disappoint at all.

Taleggio is a semi-soft, washed-rind Italian cheese known for its pungent aroma yet unexpectedly mild and fruity flavor. Here, it was beautifully fragrant, luxuriously smooth, and satisfyingly rich — light on the palate yet utterly indulgent. Biting into the tender cappellacci, the velvety Taleggio filling spilled out at just the right temperature, its delicate texture belying its deep, complex flavor. Paired with a sip of the smoky consommé, it was an utterly satisfying moment.



As a devoted lover of desserts, I naturally couldn't bear to forgo a single offering on the menu — especially when Rosetta's sweet creations looked so irresistibly enticing. There were two I was particularly eager to try, and my server, ever attentive, kindly offered to serve me half-portions of each, ensuring I could savor both without being overwhelmed.

The first was a composition of poached pears, elderflowers, and tarragon (Peras pochadas, flor de saúco y estragón). The duo of tarragon and pear bring a medley of nuanced natural freshness, and I had chosen this dish as a kind of palate cleanser to gently transition into the final moments of the meal. The tarragon ice cream was exquisitely smooth, its herbal brightness adding a crisp, refined touch.

Delicate slices of pear and a luscious pear compote layered atop it provided a clean yet elegant texture, enhancing the lightness of the dish. The elderflower espuma, subtly redolent of apples, was a delightful surprise — sublimating the entire composition with an airy, almost ethereal quality.



The final dessert was an homage to honey: Melipona honey jelly with brown butter ice cream and vanilla (Gelatina de miel melipona con helado de mantequilla avellanada y vainilla).

Melipona honey, produced by stingless bees, possesses a uniquely complex flavor —sweet yet tangy, with subtle umami depth and a lingering citrus acidity. Here, it was transformed into a delicate jelly, its sweetness slightly pronounced yet never cloying, thanks to the honey’s own intricate character, which lent an herbal freshness to the dish.

Atop the jelly rested calendula petals, while within lay mint, elderflower, and again, calendula petals. The natural floral aromas wove a fine, almost imperceptible complexity into the experience, gently shifting the layers of flavor with each bite. The brown butter ice cream is richly deep and with restrained sweetness, it offered a deep, nutty contrast, together with the vanilla sauce. The result was a dessert that shone with brightness and clarity, yet maintained an elegant depth and balance—an exquisite finale to the meal.

Overall, Rosetta’s dining experience is refined and imbued with a distinctly feminine elegance. The fusion elements are not overt, yet the restaurant’s casual, cozy atmosphere certainly establishes a foundation that keeps things from feeling too cutting-edge or experimental. It is a place well-suited for a leisurely afternoon, where the meal is easily satisfying without being mentally overwhelming. However, its ranking at No. 34 on the World’s 50 Best list may be a bit of an overstatement.